



IRS Complaint Handling Policy



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Document Information

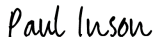
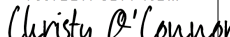
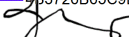
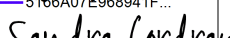
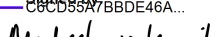
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to set forth clear expectations for identifying, investigating, and responding to complaints from consumers and regulators, including pre-suit matters and litigation, in compliance with the Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA), the Dodd-Frank Act's UDAP provisions, and other applicable state consumer protection laws.

2. Scope

The provisions of the policy apply to ibex Receivable Solutions employees.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Agents	Document oral complaints in compliance with this policy.
Client Services	Coordinate information requests and client reports, including transmitting complaint notices or special reports to clients where required.
Compliance & Risk Management	Investigate and respond to complaints, managing legal matters, policy enforcement, trend analysis, and reporting.
Human Resources	Record training, testing, and discipline.
Internal Risk Assessment Team	Conduct audits and ensure compliance with this policy.
IT Department	Develop and maintain compliance-related controls.
Legal	Provide guidance on high-risk scenarios, applicable laws and regulatory requirements. Advise on communication restrictions, and support escalation handling for litigation threats, regulatory complaints, bankruptcy matters, and attorney representation.
Management	Document oral complaints, policy enforcement, and ongoing coaching.
Quality Assurance and Compliance Analyst	Monitor and review calls and account documentation.
Training Department	Conduct new hire training, refresher training, and testing.

4. Policy and Procedures

4.1. Identifying Complaints

- 4.1.1 ibex Receivable Solutions investigates and responds to oral and written complaints from consumers, consumer representatives, regulators, state Attorney Generals, the Better Business Bureau (BBB), and other third parties.
- 4.1.2 All employees are trained to evaluate statements to determine if they fall into one or more of the following categories:
 - 4.1.2.1 Complaint
 - 4.1.2.2 Cease and Desist Request
 - 4.1.2.3 Dispute
 - 4.1.2.4 Validation Request

- 4.1.3 A complaint is any expression of dissatisfaction with how ibex Receivable Solutions or its client has interacted with the consumer or third party. Complaints generally fall into three categories:
 - 4.1.3.1 Customer service complaints
 - 4.1.3.2 Legal complaints
 - 4.1.3.3 Regulatory complaints
- 4.1.4 Complaints come in many forms. There are no magic words that must be used. Consider the following examples of allegations that are generally considered complaints (this list is not exhaustive):
 - 4.1.4.1 Abusive or harassing behavior
 - 4.1.4.2 Rude, disrespectful, insensitive, or unprofessional behavior
 - 4.1.4.3 Delays in answering phone calls, returning phone calls, or responding to consumer requests
 - 4.1.4.4 Excessive call frequency
 - 4.1.4.5 Excessive hold times
 - 4.1.4.6 Other categories as determined by client specification
- 4.1.5 A dispute is any challenge to the accuracy, validity, character, status, or amount of any debt collected by ibex Receivable Solutions, whether oral or written. Requests for information to verify or substantiate a debt and requests to investigate information reported to a credit reporting agency will also be considered disputes. For more details on how we handle disputes, refer to the Dispute Handling Policy.
- 4.1.6 A cease-and-desist request is any request for ibex Receivable Solutions to cease communications. We treat the following events as a cease-and-desist request:
 - 4.1.6.1 Attorney representation notice
 - 4.1.6.2 Cease and desist requests
 - 4.1.6.3 Notice the consumer has filed for bankruptcy
 - 4.1.6.4 Refusal to pay where required by applicable law, client instruction, or internal control rules
 - 4.1.6.5 Threats to file a lawsuit if contact does not stop
 - 4.1.6.6 Threats to file complaints with regulators, including the CFPB, FTC, BBB, OCC, Attorney General, etc. if contact does not stop
 - 4.1.6.7 Wrong number notices
- 4.1.7 If an employee is unsure how to categorize a person's statement, they should consult their manager or a member of the Compliance & Risk Management Department.

4.2. Handling Written Complaints

- 4.2.1 Consumers and third parties may send written complaints through the following methods:
 - 4.2.1.1 Mail
 - 4.2.1.2 Fax
 - 4.2.1.3 Email
 - 4.2.1.4 ibex website
- 4.2.2 When a written complaint is received, it must be forwarded to Compliance & Risk Management.

- 4.2.3 Compliance & Risk Management will evaluate the complaint to determine whether it is a complaint, dispute, a cease-and-desist request, or some combination of these.
- 4.2.4 Compliance & Risk Management will document written complaints in accordance with the Complaint Handling Procedure, which is outlined in the “Documenting Complaints” section below.

4.3. Handling Oral Complaints

- 4.3.1 If a consumer makes a complaint over the phone, the collection agent should attempt to evaluate whether the consumer is making a complaint, dispute, cease and desist request, or some combination of these.
- 4.3.2 Agents are trained to try to resolve complaints while on the phone by addressing the caller’s concerns as appropriate. This may involve providing information or explanations to help the consumer understand the situation.
- 4.3.3 If the agent is unable to address the caller’s concerns, they must escalate the call to a manager for further handling.
- 4.3.4 All complaints must be documented, even if resolved over the phone.
- 4.3.5 The agent or manager must document the complaint in accordance with the Complaint Handling Procedure, which is outlined in the “Documenting Complaints” section below.
- 4.3.6 Compliance & Risk Management will review all oral complaint entries to ensure they are properly handled.

4.4. Documenting Complaints

- 4.4.1 Compliance & Risk Management will document written complaints.
- 4.4.2 Agents will document oral complaints, including unresolved complaints and complaints resolved over the phone.
- 4.4.3 Complaints are fact-specific and should be documented in accordance with the Complaint Handling Procedure. The general rules are as follows:
 - 4.4.3.1 For all complaints, the account status must be updated to “Complaint.”
 - 4.4.3.2 The account notes should be updated to briefly summarize the complaint and provide the following information, as applicable:
 - 4.4.3.2.1 Date of complaint
 - 4.4.3.2.2 Type of complaint
 - 4.4.3.2.3 Name and contact information of person making complaint
 - 4.4.3.2.4 How the complaint was received
 - 4.4.3.2.5 Whether the complaint is against ibex Receivable Solutions, a client, or another entity
 - 4.4.3.2.6 Names of all employees involved in the complaint
 - 4.4.3.2.7 For oral complaints, whether it was resolved over the phone or whether it remains unresolved
 - 4.4.3.2.8 Other relevant information
 - 4.4.3.3 Copies of all complaint documents must be saved to the file, including copies of written complaints and any supporting documents provided.

- 4.4.4 The “Complaint” account status blocks all phones numbers and addresses to prevent additional calls or letters from being sent. It also triggers a notice to the client in accordance with client specifications.
- 4.4.5 Accounts remain in “Complaint” status until Compliance & Risk Management responds to the complaint and updates the status accordingly.
- 4.4.6 Only Compliance & Risk Management has the authority to request to change the status code of an account in “Complaint” status.

4.5. Investigating Complaints

- 4.5.1 Compliance & Risk Management will assign a compliance staff member to investigate the complaint.
- 4.5.2 Complaints are investigated by reviewing all relevant information, including, but not limited to:
 - 4.5.2.1 Account records
 - 4.5.2.2 Call recordings
 - 4.5.2.3 Complaint documents
 - 4.5.2.4 Documents provided by the person making the complaint
 - 4.5.2.5 Interviews with employees involved in the complaint
 - 4.5.2.6 Other information relevant to the specific facts alleged by the person making the complaint
- 4.5.3 Compliance & Risk Management may also coordinate with Client Services to request information from clients, if appropriate.

4.6. Responding to Complaints

- 4.6.1 When the investigation is complete, a Compliance & Risk Management staff will prepare a Complaint Investigation Report and a draft response.
- 4.6.2 The report and draft response will first be reviewed by the SVP of Compliance & Risk Management before being submitted to the Legal Department for review and final approval, where applicable. The Legal Department will provide final approval for any response to a regulator, government agency, attorney general, the Better Business Bureau, outside counsel, or other third party, as well as for any other response that Legal determines requires its review based on the facts, legal issues presented, or applicable client requirements. The SVP of Compliance & Risk Management will provide final approval for all other complaint responses.
- 4.6.3 Upon approval, the response will be sent to the complainant, regulator, government agency, client, or other appropriate recipient, as applicable.
- 4.6.4 Human Resources and/or the Chief People Officer will be notified if any actions need to be taken for the agent (i.e., disciplinary action and/or additional training) according to the ibex Receivable Solutions disciplinary policy and oversee its completion.
- 4.6.5 Compliance & Risk Management will ensure disciplinary action is added to the Complaint Tracker Log.

4.7. Complaint Tracking, Trend Analysis, and Reporting

- 4.7.1 Compliance & Risk Management maintains a Complaint Tracker Log to document the complaint handling process.
- 4.7.2 The Complaint Tracker Log tracks the status of all complaints with separate sections for consumer/third-party individual complaints, regulatory complaints, and legal complaints.
- 4.7.3 The Complaint Tracker Log summarizes the complaint and tracks its progression through the complaint handling process. For more details, refer to the Complaint Tracker Log.
- 4.7.4 Compliance & Risk Management also retains copies of all complaint records and responsive materials for at least 6 years after creation. Records may be retained longer as required by state law, client requirements, or to preserve evidence in anticipation of litigation.
- 4.7.5 The Complaint Tracker Log is utilized to maintain records, cross-reference permissible contacts, and conduct trend analysis.
- 4.7.6 Compliance & Risk Management runs trend analysis reports based on data in the Complaint Tracker Log. This information is part of the monthly Compliance Report presented to the Oversight Review Board.
- 4.7.7 For more information on Oversight Review Board involvement and the reports they receive, refer to the Oversight Review Board Policy and the Compliance Management System Policy.

4.8. Notice to Clients

- 4.8.1 ibex Receivable Solutions clients receive notice when an account's status is changed due to a complaint.
- 4.8.2 Notice is triggered automatically by the account's status code.
- 4.8.3 Notice is delivered according to the client specification.
- 4.8.4 If the client requires a special report for complaints, it will be prepared by Compliance & Risk Management and supplied to Client Services to send to the client.

5. Auditing

Compliance & Risk Management will review accounts to ensure actions taken by an employee meet quality standards and do not violate Company policy. The Quality Assurance and Compliance Analyst will monitor call recordings and corresponding account documentation to ensure all types of complaints are handled appropriately in compliance with this policy. Compliance with this policy shall be audited by the Internal Risk Assessment team on a quarterly basis.

6. Training and Testing

All personnel will receive training on ibex's policies applicable to their position upon hire or promotion. The same Company personnel will complete attestations and assessments on those policies upon completion of training and on an annual basis. All attestations will be acknowledged and recorded through the Company's learning management system using an online acknowledgment activity

The various types of complaints are covered in the FDCPA, UDAP, and state law sections of our compliance training and testing programs. During new hire training, agents learn to recognize all types of complaints expressed in various ways and learn how to determine whether a consumer is making a complaint, dispute, validation request, cease and desist request, refusal to pay, or some combination of those categories. All new hires are required to pass compliance tests. Existing employees are retested annually.

7. Enforcement

Violations of this policy will not be tolerated. Infractions will subject an employee to corrective discipline up to and including termination of employment.

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Details of Changes	Change By	Reviewed By	Approved By
1.0	06/22/2020	Creation	Sandra Fernandez	Paul Inson Sandra Fernandez	Paul Inson Sandra Fernandez
2.0	08/10/2022	Updated	Lloyd Macatangay	Flara Jaculina	Paul Inson Sandra Fernandez
2.1	10/05/2023	Moved to new template	Lloyd Macatangay	Flara Jaculina	Privacy Board: Jim Ferrato Paul Inson Sandra Fernandez Mubbshar Ismail Jason Malmberg
2.2	12/05/2024	Annual review – No changes	Lloyd Macatangay	Flara Jaculina	Privacy Board: Christy O'Connor Paul Inson Sandra Fernandez Mubbshar Ismail Jason Malmberg

Version	Date	Details of Changes	Change By	Reviewed By	Approved By
3.0	03/31/2026	Minor grammar & punctuation updates Update all reference of "Compliance" to "Compliance & Risk Management" Added Legal to Roles and Responsibilities, clarified Client Services, and updated "Customer Security Team" to "Compliance Analyst." Revised refusal to pay provision related to cease-and-desist requests.	Lloyd Macatangay	Flara Jaculina Sandra Cordray Jason Malmberg	Privacy Board: Paul Inson Christy O'Connor Jason Malmberg Sandra Cordray Mubbshar Ismail